

BFS218

Racism and the Digital Age

Understanding Techno-Racism

A short, friendly map to your companion site:
what it is, where everything lives, and how to
use it across live and asynchronous weeks.

BFS218

BFS218 Synchronous Companion Site

This instructor-created site is the companion to our blended synchronous BFS218 course. Open it from Blackboard or at rpeart73.github.io/bfs218-sync/.

Everything around your class, in one site

This is the companion site for the blended synchronous section of BFS218. Weeks 1 to 5, 7 to 9, 11 and 12 meet live. Weeks 6 and 10 are independent asynchronous learning. Weeks 13 and 14 have no lecture; the usual class window becomes office hours for completion, feedback, questions, and course closure. Study Week runs Monday to Friday, October 26 to 30, with no class and no new module. Red marks published due dates and clearly labelled planning anchors where the active brief gives only a due week; black marks live classes, neutral grey marks asynchronous weeks, and a light grey outline marks Study Week. Blackboard remains the official Seneca course platform for announcements, assignment submission, grades, discussions, course records, and required administrative functions.



What it is

- Your weekly learning pathway, in working order
- Every source, concept, and self-check in one spot
- Your before-and-after-class companion, beside Blackboard



What it is not

- Not a replacement for Blackboard
- Not where announcements, submissions, discussions, grades, or course records live
- Not a place that collects student submissions or stores grades

How to use this page, on every page

At the top of every page on the site sits a bar labelled How to use this page. Open it for step-by-step instructions written for that exact page: what to click, what may use temporary browser storage, what is never graded, and where to go next. If a page ever feels unfamiliar, that bar is the fastest way to teach yourself.

PRIVACY, ACCESSIBILITY, AND COPYRIGHT

Use it alongside Blackboard

This site does not require an account, collect student submissions, or store grades. The course site's own JavaScript does not transmit your optional name, notes, check answers, or Assignment Start Lab responses. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can prevent or remove it. Download anything you need to keep. Opening an external link, loading external media, or sending the prefilled problem-report email contacts that provider.

Course readings and media are linked for educational use. Copyright remains with the original creators and publishers. Students should access readings through the provided links, Seneca library access, or Blackboard where applicable. Students who experience barriers using the site should use Blackboard and contact the instructor so access can be supported.

START HERE

Start on Home, then How This Site Works

Home is the first item in the course menu; it opens the weekly journey. How This Site Works sits right below it and explains what this companion site does, what still belongs in Blackboard, what may use temporary browser storage, and how to clear locally stored work on a shared device.

The site opens without an unsolicited dialog. Open How This Site Works from the menu whenever you want the orientation, and use the Report a problem button in Site Support if something does not work.

THE WHOLE SITE, AT A GLANCE

The menu is the map

Home comes first and opens the weekly journey; How This Site Works sits right below it, holding the site boundaries, privacy controls, and reset option. The rest of the menu is grouped by the work you are doing.

Starting Your Assignment and Career Choices open from the Home page and the weekly pages.

● ● ● BFS218, navigation	
ORIENT	
01 Home The course as a journey: every week, its guiding question, and where you are	02 How This Site Works What the site is, what it is not, privacy, the built-in site instructions, and the Clear my saved work control
03 Calendar and Due Dates Every date on one page, the current on-site Coming up banner, and the 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time deadline rule	
WEEKLY JOURNEY	
04 Weeks 1 to 14 The whole term as a list of weeks; open any week to see that week's page	
LEARN EACH WEEK	
05 Interactive Lessons One guided lesson per teaching week, Weeks 2 to 12. A lesson is one part of its week, not the whole week	06 Lectures A short weekly audio lecture, written by your professor and read by an AI narrator, to catch up if you missed the live class
STUDY THE SOURCES	
07 Readings and Media Every assigned source, as a searchable card	08 Videos and Podcasts Scholar media, loaded only when you choose to play
09 Source Practice Turn any source into practice questions, with a lens	10 Compare Sources Hold up to three sources side by side, every idea attributed
PRACTISE AND APPLY	
11 Concept Flashcards Flip cards for every week, no course marks	12 Glossary Every key term, always cited to its reading
13 Term Review A cumulative review of the whole term, gathered in one place	14 What This Course Builds The course outcomes and the skills each week develops
SITE SUPPORT	
15 Report a problem	

A button that emails the instructor if something on the site does not work

HOME

The course as a journey

Home shows the full course rhythm. Each week carries a short LIVE or ASYNC badge, and the legend explains the colours. Live weeks use the before-class and after-class rhythm. Asynchronous weeks replace the lecture with a clear independent purpose. Every live week has a visible recording space; the captioned recording appears there after it is processed and posted. The journey lays the course out week by week, each station carrying the week's title and its **guiding question**.

- 1 Click any week station to open that week's page.
- 2 Coming back later? Browser storage may let the site reopen where you left off on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove that temporary record. Download anything you need to keep.

The screenshot shows the Seneca Polytechnic BFS218 Companion website. The header includes the Seneca Polytechnic logo, the course title 'BFS218 Companion', a search bar with 'Reading Lens', a 'Listen' button, and navigation links for 'SYNCHRONOUS', 'LIVE ONLINE CLASSES', 'SYB · TUE 12:00-1:00', and 'FALL 2026'. The main content area is divided into a left sidebar and a main panel. The sidebar, under the 'ORIENT' dropdown, contains links for 'Home', 'How This Site Works', 'Calendar and Due Dates', 'WEEKLY JOURNEY Weeks 1-14', and 'LEARN EACH WEEK'. The main panel features a 'See this course through your program:' dropdown set to 'General stream / no program'. Below this is a 'How to use this page' section with an 'Open' button. The central focus is the 'COURSE BEGINS' section for 'Week 1: Introduction to the Course' (Week of Sept 8), which has an 'Open >' button. To the right, a 'NEXT DUE' section lists 'Compass Check' (October 23 - in 76 days) and 'Canadian Case File' (November 6 - in 90 days), both with external link icons.

HOME · THE COURSE JOURNEY, EACH WEEK WITH ITS GUIDING QUESTION

See the course through your program

BFS218 asks how racism travels through technology, and that question lands differently depending on where you are headed. Right on Home you can reframe the whole course around your own program of study, so techno-racism shows up in the tools and systems your field builds and uses every day.

- 1 On Home, find the control that says **See this course through your program**. Pick your program from the dropdown of Seneca programs, grouped by area of study. You can also pick a whole area, or choose **Still exploring**.
- 2 You stay on Home. Nothing navigates away. A short **For your field** panel appears at the top, tying the whole course to your program.
- 3 Each week on the journey gains its own short **For your field** line, and the weeks that matter most to your field are marked **Key for your field**.
- 4 For the deeper write-up, open **Career Choices** from the menu. It gives you three clear sections: program context, how techno-racism connects to that field, and how to use the lens in course work.
- 5 A small chip at the top shows **Viewing as your program**, with a way to change it or turn it off during the current session.

A lens, not a different course

Every student reads the same readings and does the same assessments. The lens only changes how the course is framed for you, it never changes what is required. You can turn it off any time, and the chip at the top of the page is how you do it.

Anatomy of a week

Every week page begins with an always-visible explanation of how that week works. Live weeks include the class-recording space. Asynchronous weeks explain why there is no lecture and what the independent time is

for. Work the remaining sections in order, top to bottom.

This week in 80 seconds. Most content weeks open with a short animated overview under the week title, made with NotebookLM from that week's readings and reviewed by your instructor. Captions available on the player. It is a fast on-ramp into the week, not a substitute for the readings.

Study Guide. Before the Knowledge Check, each teaching week carries a rehearsal space: a quick warm-up from earlier weeks, explain-it-back cards where you put each key concept in your own words and compare with the reading, and a question ladder that works the week's guiding questions from recall to application. These notes are not submitted or graded and earn no course marks. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it.

Knowledge Check. Every content week closes with an optional self-check that may show a practice result but carries no course marks. Set A and Set B are multiple choice, this week's ideas plus a short review from earlier weeks; Set C is different where the week offers it, with short scenarios, matching, and a written reflection you compare against a model. After you answer, you can say how sure you were, and the summary shows not just what you got right but where a confident answer was actually wrong, the thing most worth fixing. These answers are not submitted or graded. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it; clear or change any answer for a fresh set.

- 1 **This week's focus**, the question and learning sequence that organize the week.
- 2 **Overview & How this week works**, read this first; it tells you what to do and in what order.
- 3 **Purpose & Outcomes**, what you should be able to do by the end. Test yourself against these sentences.
- 4 **Guiding Questions**, carry at least one with you into the readings.
- 5 **Key Concepts**, each explained and cited to that week's reading, so you always know where an idea comes from.
- 6 **Readings**, full citation and a button. Open access, Seneca Library, Read on Blackboard, or Revisit from an earlier week.
- 7 **The Interactive Lesson**, an interactive chapter sequence embedded on the page. Enter it, make choices, inspect the evidence, and use the Arrow keys to move between chapters.
- 8 **The Activity**, press Start and follow the prompts. Practice, not assessment.
- 9 **Reflect**, a short prompt (one or two sentences) to close the week.
- 10 **You can now**, the week's closing checklist. Tick what you can genuinely do; anything left unticked shows exactly what to revisit. Reset any time.

Seneca
 POLYTECHNIC

BFS218 Companion

SYNCHRONOUS · LIVE ONLINE CLASSES

SYB · TUE 12:00-1:00

ORIENT

WEEKLY JOURNEY Week 3

1 Introduction to the Course 0

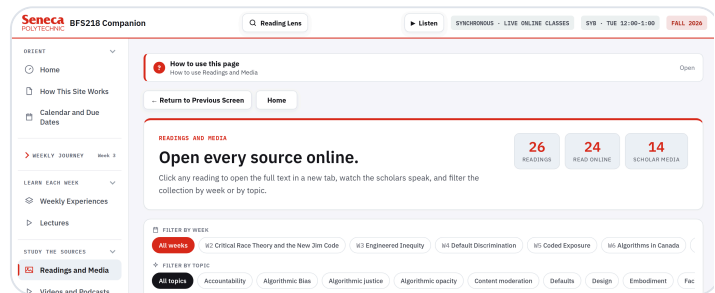
2 Critical Race Theory 5

A WEEK PAGE · EVERYTHING IN WORKING ORDER, TOP TO BOTTOM

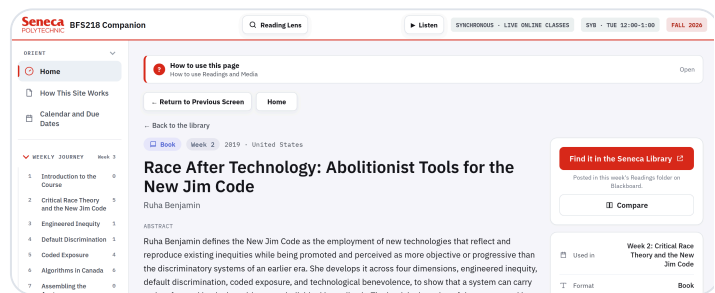
Every source, as a card

The library holds every course reading: what it is, what it argues, how long it takes, and how to reach it.

- 1 Search any author, title, or idea.
- 2 Filter to one week with the week strip, or browse by format.
- 3 Click a card for the reading's page: core idea, plain-language abstract, level and length, and where the text lives.
- 4 Press the red button to open the reading. A Source page button appears where a separate source or DOI exists.
- 5 Bookmark a reading to your Saved shelf. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it; note anything you need to keep.



EVERY SOURCE AS A CARD, SEARCHABLE BY WEEK

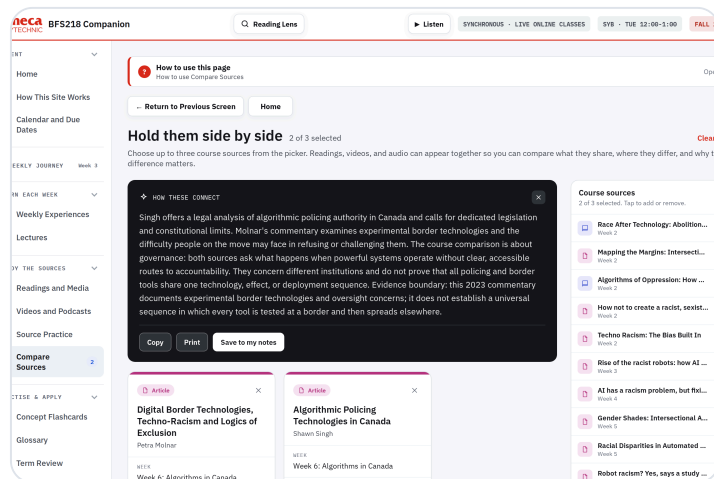


A READING PAGE · CORE IDEA, ABSTRACT, AND THE OPEN BUTTON

COMPARE SOURCES

Hold up to three sources side by side

- 1 Open Compare from the menu, or press Compare on any reading page.
- 2 Pick up to three readings. Each becomes a column: week, year, origin, length, level, and core idea.
- 3 With two or more selected, press **Synthesize their relationship**. The site explains how they speak to each other, every idea attributed.
- 4 With three, it takes the pairings one at a time, then asks what only appears when all three are on the table.
- 5 Remove a reading with the × on its column, or Clear all to start over.



EACH PAIRING EXPLAINED, EVERY IDEA ATTRIBUTED

Turn any source into practice

Choose a reading, choose a lens, and answer. Every answer comes back with a short explanation grounded in the reading itself, so a wrong answer still teaches you something specific.

LENS 01

Thematic

What it is about.

LENS 02

Argument

What it claims, and why.

LENS 03

Context

Where it sits in the field and the course.

GLOSSARY

Never defined out of thin air

- Browse by week (including the closing weeks) or search any term.
- Every definition carries a citation to that week's assigned reading.
- The *Scholars this week* strip introduces the people behind the readings. Click a name to jump to their reading.

CONCEPT FLASHCARDS

Practice, no course marks

- Pick a week, or take all weeks together.
- Flip the cards: term on the front, definition and citation on the back.
- For question practice, each week page closes with its own Knowledge Check. The interface may show correctness or a practice result, but answers are not submitted or graded and earn no course marks. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it; use the practice to see what to reread.



Interactive Lessons hub. The lessons for Weeks 2 to 12 all live in one place. Open Interactive Lessons from the menu and choose a week to start it again without hunting.

HANDS-ON

The studios & labs

Alongside the weekly activities, the site carries hands-on labs. Each one tells you what you are doing and why before you start. The companion site does not submit or grade this lab work; it earns no course marks.

Evidence Transfer Lab

Move a claim from source to argument, deliberately.

Accountability Chain Lab

Trace who answers for a harm, link by link.

Self-Check Studio

Package your studio work as a Word document to keep.

Browse it however you think

By week

Everything, week by week.

Tiles

The whole library as a wall you can scan.

Index

The alphabetical list.

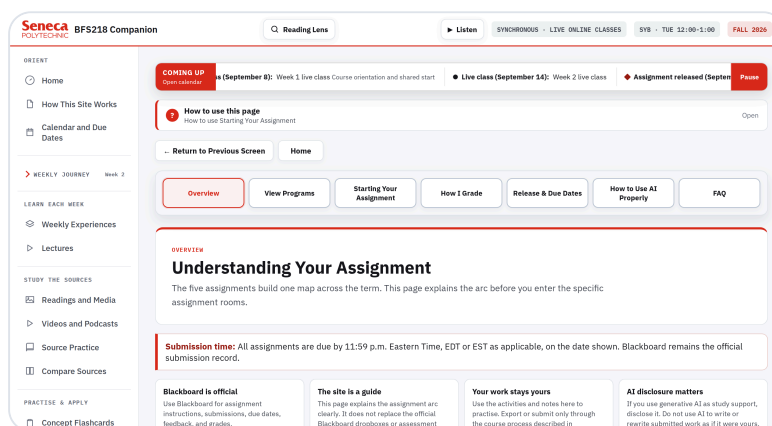
WHEN BEGINNING FEELS DIFFICULT

Make a small, realistic start plan

Use [the seven current assignment guides](#) for the complete tasks, marking criteria and submission steps. The release and due dates are listed below. Blackboard holds your submissions, feedback and grades.

What it creates. Fixed course rules combine your answers into a personal starting point, course-specific next actions, a success target for the next work session, useful questions, and the right human support routes. The plan also explains why each pathway was selected. No AI is used.

How your plan is handled. The companion site's own code does not upload, submit, score, grade, or send your name, context, answers, or plan to the instructor. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can prevent or remove it. Print or save the plan as a PDF, or copy it as text.



A PERSONAL PLAN • READY TO PRINT OR SAVE AS PDF

Choose the amount of support you need. For most BFS218 assignments, use the lab for a quick PDF plan or the Starter Studio for a more detailed Word preparation pack. For **Decision Lab: Scenario Choices and Reflection**, the lab helps you plan your evidence and follow-up preparation. It does not choose scenario options or write the four graded responses for you.

Blackboard remains official. Always return there for the complete brief, rubric, due date, submission link, and recorded grade. The lab helps you begin; it does not write the assignment or replace the instructor's requirements.

A rhythm that works

STEP 1

Open the week page early and read the overview.

STEP 2

Do the readings with one guiding question in hand.

STEP 3

Start the interactive lesson and follow its chapters.

STEP 4

Do the activity.

STEP 5

Tick the You can now checklist honestly.

Before each assignment, use **Compare** on the readings you plan to write about, and run the **Knowledge Check** at the end of those weeks.

PRACTICAL NOTES

Good to know

- Works on phones, tablets, and laptops, and is designed for keyboard navigation.
- Browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can prevent or remove that copy.
- Browser storage may keep a temporary copy of your saved shelf, notes, and check answers on this device; this companion-site work is not submitted or graded and earns no course marks, though checks may show a practice result.
- If the site looks stale after an announced update, refresh the page once.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS

When in doubt, Blackboard wins.

BFS218 synchronous companion site. Blackboard remains the official course platform for submissions, grades, announcements, discussions, and course records.

Where to go for what

Start this week's work	Home ► click the week ► work top to bottom
Find a source fast	Readings and Media ► search or week strip
See how sources connect	Compare Sources ► pick up to three
Test yourself on a source	Source Practice ► pick a lens
Look up a term	Glossary ► search
Drill before an assessment	Concept Flashcards ► pick the weeks
Start the week's lesson	Interactive Lessons ► pick the week
Submit anything / check grades	Blackboard, always

Reading Lens and other study supports

The **Reading Lens** button at the top of every page opens reading supports that apply across the whole site: text size from 75 to 175 percent, comfortable spacing, a high-legibility font, nine page tints (including a blue light filter that warms the whole screen), a reading ruler that follows your pointer (choose its width, pin it in place, and drag it by hand), a large-print magnifier docked at the bottom of the screen, and read-aloud in your choice of the voices on your own device; a Listen button also sits at the top of every page. Inside a lesson, use the header's **A minus**, **A plus**, and **Reset** controls to set lesson text from 100 to 200 percent or restart the lesson. The Accessibility panel offers Light, Soft grey, Warm, and High contrast screen themes, plus a high-legibility font and reduced motion. Dense chapters scroll vertically at readable size instead of shrinking their text. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy of these choices on this device; browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can reset them. A Reset all supports button returns everything to default.

Do not save your work on this site. Notes and check answers are not submitted or graded and earn no course marks; checks may show a practice result. Browser storage may keep a temporary copy on this device, but browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it. Draft anything graded in your own documents, and at the end of any week download your notes with **Generate Your Weekly Notes**. On a shared or lab computer, the How This Site Works page has a one-click **Clear my saved work** control.

Week pages start folded. Each week opens as a clean map of headings. Press the button beside any heading to open just that section, up to two sections stay open at once (opening a third folds the earliest), and you can fold any section back down when you finish it. Sections fold again when you leave the week, so every visit starts from the clean map, and jumping to a section from the side list opens it for you.

Your study compass. When browser storage is available, the home page may read activity temporarily kept on this device (weeks opened, checks tried, reflections written) and offer up to three next steps. It uses a few fixed rules, not AI, and the course site's own JavaScript does not transmit that activity. You can add your first name so the site greets you; browser storage may keep a temporary local copy. Browser settings, private browsing, clearing site data, shared-device use, or changing devices can remove it, and Clear my saved work removes it when present.

Coming up and phone access. The current schedule stays at the top while you move through the site. Pause freezes the message exactly where it is and keeps the text visible. Select the persistent Coming Up banner to open Calendar and Due Dates; no dialog opens automatically. On a phone, Calendar and Due Dates offers a live calendar subscription. How This Site Works gives you the same site link to share or copy to another device. Blackboard remains the official source if a date changes.

Work inside every 3D activity. Each week uses the visual style that best fits its task: technical inspection, workshop, civic policy, or cartographic mapping. Drag to turn the scene, pinch or scroll to zoom, or use the view buttons. The default view shows the whole environment. Numbered explanations sit below the model so they do not block the evidence. Weeks with simulations let you change inputs, run repeated trials, and compare uncertain outcomes. A positive result can occur, but the underlying rules still shape which outcomes are more likely. The lesson uses the same week model so the teaching and activity stay aligned.

If something breaks. Interactive Lessons open full screen. Close the lesson to return to the course page and menu. If a model, recording, or video will not load, or anything looks wrong, use Report a problem on How This Site Works. It opens a prefilled email to the instructor; sending it contacts your email provider and the instructor. No phone number is shown. If the site is unavailable, everything required for the course is also on Blackboard.

Privacy. No third-party content loads automatically. A third-party service is contacted only when you choose to open an external link or load external media. YouTube uses its privacy-enhanced player, and each external service applies its own privacy practices.

Experiments. Most weekly activities in BFS218 open with a short experiment: commit to a prediction, run it, read what actually happened, and see your own prediction mirrored back. The mirror names the thinking move you used, and across weeks it shows the pattern in your first instincts. The companion site does not submit or grade it; it earns no course marks.

[Current assessment instructions, dates, submission steps, and grading criteria](#)

Assessment release and submission dates

All dates are in 2026 and use Eastern Time. Assessments open at 12:01 a.m.; submissions are due at 11:59 p.m. You can preview the public website, but Blackboard controls the assessment opening dates. Larger tasks have longer working windows. Instructions identify earlier feedback to use when one task builds on another.

BFS218 SYB deadlines. All times are Eastern Time (ET).

Assignment	Opens	Posted deadline	48-hour window ends
1. Live Systems Notebook: Set 1 (10%)	September 15, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	September 25, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	September 27, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
2. Decision Lab: Scenario Choices and Reflection (20%)	October 8, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	October 13, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	October 15, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
3. Canadian Technology Hearing (20%)	October 8, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	October 20, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	October 22, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
4. Live Systems Notebook: Set 2 (10%)	November 3, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	November 13, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	November 15, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
5. Design the Repair Studio (20%)	November 16, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	November 29, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	December 1, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET
6. Personal Cartography (15%)	November 26, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	December 11, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	No automatic window
7. Final Learning Reflection (5%)	December 7, 2026 12:01 a.m. ET	December 13, 2026 11:59 p.m. ET	No automatic window

The first three assessments total 50%; their standard submission windows close by October 22. This schedule allows ten calendar days for marking before the second half begins November 2. No assessment is due during Study Week, October 26 to 30. The final scheduled submission is December 13.

Deadlines and Extensions

Posted deadlines

Submit through Blackboard by the posted deadline. All dates and times use Eastern Time. Saving a draft is not the same as submitting; check for Blackboard's submission confirmation.

Regular assignments: 48 hours without a penalty

Regular assignments have an automatic 48-hour submission window after the posted deadline, without a grade penalty. You do not need permission to use this window. Each assessment shows its posted deadline and the exact date and time the window ends. Blackboard may label a submission made during this window as late; that label does not mean a penalty applies.

Request an extension BEFORE the posted deadline

Routine extension requests must reach me before the original posted deadline. The 48-hour submission window does not extend the deadline for requesting an extension. Routine requests made during or after that window will not be approved. A request made before the deadline does not guarantee approval.

After the 48-hour window

Work submitted after the standard 48-hour window receives zero unless an extension or exception has been approved. Blackboard may still allow an upload so approved exceptions can be handled; an available submission box does not extend the acceptance deadline.

Unexpected emergencies and accommodations

If an unexpected emergency arises, or prevents you from contacting me earlier, contact me as soon as possible. Exceptional circumstances are considered individually. Approved accommodations remain in effect and determine your applicable arrangements. Contact me privately rather than posting personal information in the course-question forum.

Scheduled live assessments

Scheduled live assessments or presentation components do not have an automatic 48-hour window. Contact me before the scheduled time if you cannot attend, or as soon as possible if an emergency prevents advance contact. Any written or recorded alternative follows the submission instructions for that assessment.

Final projects and the Final Learning Reflection

Final projects are due December 11, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. Eastern. The Final Learning Reflection is due December 13, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. Eastern. These final assignments have no automatic 48-hour window. Routine extension requests must arrive before the posted deadline. Approved accommodations and exceptional circumstances are handled individually.

If Blackboard prevents submission

Contact me promptly and keep evidence of the problem, such as the error message and time. Email is for reporting the issue, not the normal assessment submission route. I will explain how to proceed if a technical problem requires another arrangement.

[Read the policy and exact course deadlines online.](#)